

SURFACE

1. Passage anchor

> “**On the surface**, it may not sound like the most exciting gift in the world...”

Passage meaning

****on the surface**** = judging only by outward appearance or first impression, without considering deeper reality

****表面上；乍看之下；從表面來看****

Here, the fountain pen may seem ordinary at first, but its deeper personal meaning makes it special.

Practice

1. ****On the surface****, the gift seemed simple.

****表面上看****，這份禮物似乎很簡單。

2. The idea looks easy ****on the surface****, but it is actually quite complex.

這個想法****乍看之下****很容易，但其實相當複雜。

Core meanings of SURFACE

2. surface — outermost part of something

= the outside or top layer of an object

****表面；外層****

Examples

1. The table has a smooth ****surface****.

桌子的****表面****很光滑。

2. Dust covered the ****surface**** of the shelf.

灰塵覆蓋了架子的****表面****。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. surface of water

= top boundary of water or another liquid

****水面；液面****

Examples

1. Leaves floated on the ****surface of the water****.

樹葉漂浮在****水面****上。

2. The swimmer came back to the ****surface****.

游泳者重新浮上****水面****。

Ground / terrain

4. surface — ground or terrain

= top layer of the ground, road, floor, or other area people move across

****地面；路面****

Examples

1. The road ****surface**** was wet.

****路面****是濕的。

2. The moon has a rocky ****surface****.

月球有岩石質的****表面****。

5. road surface

= upper layer of a road

****路面****

Examples

1. Ice formed on the ****road surface****.

****路面****結冰了。

2. The damaged ****surface**** made driving difficult.

受損的****路面****令駕駛變得困難。

Geometry / mathematics

6. surface — boundary of a three-dimensional object

= outer boundary of a solid object

****表面；曲面****

Examples

1. A sphere has a curved ****surface****.

球體有一個彎曲的****表面****。

2. The points lie on the ****surface**** of the object.

這些點位於物體的****表面****。

7. surface area

= total area covering the outside of an object

****表面積****

Examples

1. We calculated the ****surface area**** of the cube.

我們計算了立方體的****表面積****。

2. Smaller particles have a greater ****surface area**** relative to volume.

較小的粒子相對於體積有較大的****表面積****。

Figurative outward appearance

8. surface — outward appearance

= what can be seen or noticed immediately, as opposed to deeper reality

****表面；外在現象****

Examples

1. Beneath the calm ****surface****, she was worried.

在平靜的****表面****之下，她其實很擔心。

2. The problem looked simple on the ****surface****.

這個問題從****表面上看****很簡單。

9. on the surface

= apparently; judging only from what is immediately visible

****表面上；乍看之下****

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. ****On the surface****, everything seemed normal.

****表面上看****，一切似乎正常。

2. The two plans look similar ****on the surface****.

這兩個方案****乍看之下****很相似。

10. beneath / below the surface

= hidden beneath outward appearances

****表面之下；在看不見的深層****

Examples

1. There was tension ****beneath the surface****.

****表面之下****其實存在緊張氣氛。

2. The film explores emotions ****below the surface****.

這部電影探討****表象之下****的情感。

Become visible / known

11. surface — verb: come to the top

= rise to the top of water or another substance

****浮上表面；浮出水面****

Examples

1. The diver ****surfaced**** after several minutes.

潛水員幾分鐘後****浮出水面****。

2. Air bubbles ****surfaced**** near the boat.

氣泡在船附近****浮到水面****。

12. surface — verb: become known or noticeable

= appear or become known after being hidden

****浮現；曝光；被發現****

Examples

1. New evidence ****surfaced**** during the investigation.

調查期間有新證據****浮現****。

2. Several problems ****surfaced**** after the launch.

推出後出現了幾個問題。

Very common figurative verb sense.

Reappear after absence

13. surface — appear again

= appear publicly again after being absent or hidden

****重新出現；露面****

Examples

1. He ****surfaced**** again several weeks later.

幾週後他再次****露面****。

2. The missing document finally ****surfaced****.

那份失蹤的文件終於****重新出現****。

Bring something to the surface

14. surface something

= cause something hidden to become visible or known

****使浮現；揭露****

Examples

1. The discussion ****surfaced several concerns****.
討論****帶出了幾項憂慮****。
2. The review ****surfaced a number of problems****.
審查****揭露了多個問題****。

This transitive use exists, especially in professional/business contexts.

Cover / finish a surface

15. surface — verb: cover with a material

= put a layer or material on the surface of something

****鋪設表面；加上表層****

Examples

1. The road was ****surfaced with asphalt****.
道路表面****鋪上了瀝青****。
2. The path was ****surfaced with stone****.
小徑表面****鋪上石材****。

16. resurface

A. put a new surface on something

****重新鋪設表面****

1. The road will be ****resurfaced**** next month.
這條道路下個月會****重新鋪設路面****。

B. appear again

****再次出現；重新浮現****

2. Old memories began to ****resurface****.
舊回憶開始****重新浮現****。

Very useful family member.

Computing / interface

17. surface — bring information forward

In product/design/business language:

= make information, content, or options visible or easier to notice

****呈現；顯示；帶出****

Examples

1. The app ****surfaces**** relevant information automatically.

這個應用程式會自動****呈現相關資訊****。

2. The search tool ****surfaces**** the most useful results first.

搜尋工具會先****顯示最有用的結果****。

Modern professional/technical use.

Military / transport

18. surface ship

= military ship that operates on the surface of the sea rather than underwater

****水面艦艇****

Examples

1. The navy deployed several ****surface ships****.

海軍部署了數艘****水面艦艇****。

2. A submarine operates differently from a ****surface vessel****.

潛艇和****水面艦艇****的運作方式不同。

Specialist but established.

Air / ground contrast

19. surface transport

= transportation operating on land or water rather than by air

****地面 / 水面運輸****

Examples

1. The goods were sent by ****surface transport****.

貨物經由****地面運輸****送出。

2. ****Surface mail**** is slower than airmail.

****平郵 / 海陸郵件****比航空郵件慢。

Lower-priority established use.

Related forms

20. superficial

= concerned only with the surface or obvious features; not deep or thorough

****表面的；膚淺的****

Examples

1. The report gives only a ****superficial analysis****.

這份報告只提供****表面的分析****。

2. Their similarities are ****superficial****.

他們的相似之處只是****表面的****。

Important semantic family, though the form is historically/lexically related rather than a simple productive derivative.

21. superficially

= only at the surface level or without depth

****表面上；膚淺地****

Examples

1. The two designs are ****superficially similar****.

兩個設計****表面上相似****。

2. He understood the issue only ****superficially****.

他對這個問題只作了****膚淺的理解****。

22. resurfacing

= act of replacing a surface, or process of something reappearing

****重新鋪面；重新浮現****

Examples

1. Road ****resurfacing**** begins next week.

道路****重鋪工程****下週開始。

2. The ****resurfacing**** of old concerns caused tension.

舊有憂慮的****重新浮現****造成了緊張。

High-value expressions

23. scratch the surface

= deal with or understand only a small, superficial part of something

****只觸及皮毛；僅了解表面****

Examples

1. One lesson can only ****scratch the surface**** of this topic.

一堂課只能****觸及這個主題的皮毛****。

2. We have barely ****scratched the surface**** of the problem.

我們對這個問題還只是****了解皮毛****。

Very high-value idiom.

24. barely scratch the surface

= explore only a very small portion of a large subject

****僅僅觸及皮毛****

Examples

1. The article **"barely scratches the surface"**.

這篇文章只是**稍微觸及皮毛**。

2. Even this long report **"barely scratches the surface"** of the issue.

即使這份長篇報告也只是**略微觸及問題表面**。

25. rise to the surface

Literal:

= move upward to the top

浮到表面 / 水面

Figurative:

= become visible, obvious, or conscious

浮現 ; 顯露

Examples

1. Oil **"rose to the surface"** of the water.

油**浮到水面**。

2. Old tensions **"rose to the surface"** again.

舊有的緊張關係再次**浮現**。

26. come to the surface

= become visible, apparent, or known

浮現 ; 顯露出來

Examples

1. Several disagreements **"came to the surface"**.

幾項分歧**浮現出來**。

2. Her frustration eventually **"came to the surface"**.

她的挫折感最終**顯露出來**。

Key contrasts

27. surface vs top

****surface****

= outermost boundary or layer of something

****表面****

****top****

= highest part or uppermost position

****頂部；上面****

Compare:

> the ****surface**** of a table

> 桌面

> the ****top**** of a mountain

> 山頂

A surface does not have to be physically highest.

28. surface vs exterior

****surface****

= outermost layer that can be touched or seen

****表面****

****exterior****

= outside part of an object/building as opposed to its interior

****外部；外觀****

29. surface vs appearance

****appearance****

= how someone or something looks

****外表；外觀****

****surface****

figuratively contrasts obvious outward signs with deeper reality.

Compare:

> Her ****appearance**** changed.

> 她的外表變了。

> ****On the surface****, she seemed calm.

> 表面上，她似乎很冷靜。

30. surface vs superficial

****surface****

can be neutral:

> surface temperature

> 表面溫度

****superficial****

often means lacking depth and can be negative:

> superficial understanding

> 膚淺的理解

So ****surface-level**** and ****superficial**** may overlap, but ****superficial**** often carries stronger criticism.

31. surface vs emerge

****surface****

= appear after being hidden, often suggesting something has come into view or become known

****emerge****

= come out, appear, or become known more generally

Compare:

> New evidence ****surfaced****.

> 新證據浮現。

> A new pattern ****emerged****.

> 一個新模式逐漸出現。

Meaning map

The central concept of ****surface**** is:

****the outermost visible boundary of something****

From this develop:

Physical object

table surface

→ ****表面****

Liquid

water surface

→ ****水面****

Ground

road surface

→ ****路面****

Mathematics

surface of a solid

→ ****表面 / 曲面****

Figurative appearance

on the surface

→ ****表面上****

Hidden vs visible

beneath the surface

→ ****表象之下****

Movement upward

surface from underwater

→ ****浮出水面****

Hidden information

evidence surfaces

→ ****浮現 / 曝光****

Reappearance

memories resurface

→ **重新浮現**

Construction

surface a road

→ **鋪設路面**

Modern information use

surface relevant content

→ **把重要資訊呈現出來**

The passage uses the figurative outward-appearance branch:

> **On the surface**

> → **只看表面 / 第一印象時**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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surface — outer layer	物體最外面可見或可觸摸的部分；表面
surface of water	水或液體最上層的界面；水面 / 液面
surface — ground/road	地面、路面或人行走其上的最上層
surface — mathematics	三維物體的外部邊界；表面 / 曲面
surface area	物體外部所有表面的總面積；表面積
surface — outward appearance	與深層現實相對的外在表現 / 表象
on the surface	只按表面或第一印象判斷；表面上 / 乍看之下
beneath/below the surface	隱藏在表象之下、更深層的
surface — rise from water	從水下升至水面；浮出水面
surface — become known	原本隱藏的資訊、問題等被發現或顯露；浮現 / 曝光
surface — reappear	原本消失或隱藏的人 / 事再次出現
surface something	使隱藏的問題或資訊顯現出來；揭露 / 帶出
surface a road/material	在道路或物體上鋪設 / 加上表層材料
resurface — road	重新鋪設路面或表層
resurface — figurative	記憶、問題、情緒等再次浮現
surface information/content	在系統中把相關資訊或內容呈現出來、提高可見度
surface ship/vessel	在海面而非水下運作的水面艦艇
superficial	只停留在表面、缺乏深度的；膚淺的
superficially	只從表面來看；缺乏深入地
scratch the surface	只開始了解或處理極小的一部分；僅觸及皮毛

| ****rise/come to the surface**** | 實際浮上表面；比喻隱藏問題、情緒等顯露出來 |

Passage recap

> **“On the surface**, it may not sound like the most exciting gift in the world...”

Here:

on the surface = **when judged only by outward appearance or first impression**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **表面上**

* **乍看之下**

* **從表面來看**

Natural contextual translation:

表面上看，這份禮物也許不算特別令人興奮。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

on the surface

= **when considering only what is immediately obvious, rather than the deeper reality**

表面上；乍看之下

The passage creates an important contrast:

> **on the surface**

> → 只是一支普通的鋼筆，看似沒甚麼特別

but:

> **beneath the surface**

> → 它象徵姐姐的理解、鼓勵和信任

So this is not the literal:

> table **surface**

> → 桌面

It is the figurative:

> ****on the surface****

> → ****只看表面 / 第一印象而言****.